

CAREER PORTFOLIO

KARIM ELSARHA

Planning Leader

Strategic Supply Chain & Infrastructure Procurement Leader

Transitioning toward **Investment & Promotion**

*18+ years turning negotiation, compliance, and data into measurable value
— now ready to help build SCZONE's investor partnerships.*

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ABOUT ME

A Career Built on Trust, Numbers & Negotiation



KARIM ELSARHA

SCZONE | Cairo, Egypt

A results-driven Procurement & Inventory Planning professional with 18+ years of experience across Egypt's public port and economic-zone sector. My career has been built on structured negotiation, contract governance, and data-driven decision-making — skills that translate directly into building trust-based, long-term relationships with investors and structuring agreements that work for both sides.

As SCZONE expands its investor base, I am seeking to bring that same discipline — sourcing strategy, compliance rigor, financial analysis, and relationship management — to the Investment & Promotion team.

18+

Years of Experience

35%

Procurement Cost Savings

800+

Supplier Partnerships Built

25

Team Members Led

What I Bring to Investment & Promotion



Negotiation & Relationship Building

Structured high-stakes negotiations that cut costs by up to 35% while preserving long-term trust — the same discipline needed to close durable investor agreements.



Contracts, Compliance & Governance

End-to-end contract drafting, review, and follow-up under FIDIC/USAID frameworks — reducing legal risk and cutting approval delays by 80%.



Market Intelligence & Feasibility Analysis

Market research, feasibility studies, and investor-evaluation frameworks that turn opportunity assessment into confident, well-supported decisions.



Digital Tools & AI-Driven Insight

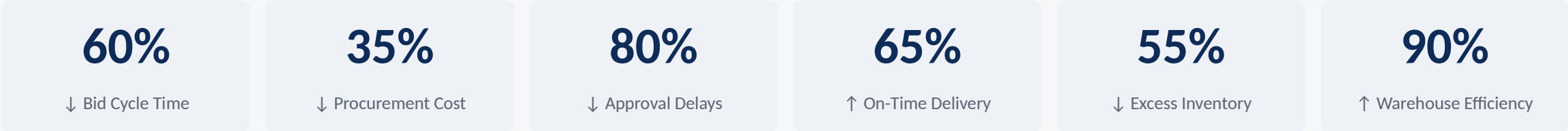
Advanced Excel & PowerPoint, Power BI dashboards, SAP MM automation, and disciplined use of AI tools to turn raw data into presentation-ready insight.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Inventory Planning Leader

Jan 2025 – Present

Suez Canal Economic Zone (SCZONE) — Cairo, Egypt



- Institutionalized full compliance with FIDIC standards and governance requirements across procurement and inventory operations.
- Executed Distribution Requirements Planning (DRP) using MIN-MAX, ABC analysis, and demand forecasting across multiple sites.
- Fed demand and inventory forecasts into cross-functional S&OP planning discussions.
- Led strategic supplier negotiations securing favorable payment terms while ensuring supply continuity.
- Deployed AI-driven demand forecasting and real-time tracking to sharply cut excess inventory.
- Mentor and lead a high-performance team of 25 procurement and inventory professionals.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Procurement & Inventory Control Specialist

May 2016 – Jan 2025

Suez Canal Economic Zone (SCZONE) — Cairo, Egypt



800+

Suppliers Qualified & Onboarded

19% of underperforming vendors were disqualified through a rigorous quality-driven evaluation system — an early version of the investor-evaluation discipline needed today.



Managed the full procurement cycle — RFQ, ITB, and RFP — ensuring bid compliance and lifecycle governance.



Evaluated supplier quotes and proposals through in-depth analysis of pricing, delivery terms, technical specs, and service quality.



Conducted ongoing market research to identify sourcing opportunities and benchmark pricing against market conditions.



Oversaw day-to-day warehouse operations, ensuring accurate stock management and smooth distribution workflows.



Introduced barcode tracking for warehouse operations, improving inventory accuracy and cutting stock discrepancies.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Budgeting & Cost Accountant

Jun 2008 – May 2016

Red Sea Ports Authority (RSPA) — Suez, Egypt

The Financial Foundation Behind My Analytical Approach



Collected, analyzed, and reported operational cost data to support management decision-making and cost control.



Assessed the financial impact of changes in goods and services on overall operational costs.



Prepared and contributed to the organization's annual budget and multi-year financial forecasts.



Monitored budget performance throughout the fiscal year, flagging variances and recommending corrective action.



Collaborated with department heads to gather budget inputs and ensure strategic alignment.

This is where my budgeting, feasibility-study, and financial-evaluation instincts were formed — the same instincts an Investment & Promotion role depends on.

CASE STUDY- 1

Vessel Traffic System (VTS) Navigation Tower — Sokhna Port

THE CHALLENGE

A greenfield, highly technical maritime navigation project — with no existing specifications or in-house technical expertise to build from.

Strategic Approach

- ✔ Mapped the technical and operational risks from the ground up and built a standard reference model for the project.
- ✔ Formed a cost-neutral partnership with the Suez Canal Authority to bring in specialized maritime expertise.
- ✔ Co-developed precise tender documents aligned with international maritime standards.

Results & Impact

- ★ Awarded the contract below comparable market rates, while securing the latest available technology.
- ★ Delivered full procurement, installation, and commissioning within a tight 7-8-month timeline.
- ★ Measurably improved maritime safety, operational throughput, and real-time tracking across the port.

Enterprise Inventory Control & Strategic Planning — SCZONE

THE SCOPE

Full ownership of inventory planning, reorder thresholds, and asset control across multiple ports and economic hubs.

Strategic Approach

- ✔ Set dynamic Min/Max reorder points to prevent stockouts and free up working capital tied in excess stock.
- ✔ Catalogued, photographed, and condition-assessed terminal telecom and IT equipment for full audit transparency.
- ✔ Ran multi-year trend analysis on operational supplies to guide smarter resource allocation.

Why It Matters

- ★ Built the same asset-verification discipline that underpins credible investor due-diligence.
- ★ Turned scattered inventory data into a governed, audit-ready system across every site.
- ★ Reinforced the financial discipline needed for accurate budgeting and feasibility work.



Warehouse & Custody System Automation

THE CHALLENGE

Warehouse records were tracked manually on paper and in scattered Excel files — locating an employee's processing a return meant a slow, file-by-file manual search.

Approach

- ✓ Independently built an integrated system using Excel Power Query, Power BI, and Access to consolidate scattered records into one structured database.
- ✓ Designed an instant search-by-employee-name feature, replacing manual file-by-file lookups.
- ✓ Structured the system around two core functions: personal custody tracking and returns processing.

Impact

- ★ Now used daily by the staff responsible for personal custody records and returns.
- ★ Replaced slow manual searches with instant, name-based lookup.
- ★ Delivered entirely through individual effort — no external vendor or system integrator involved.



Warehouse Regulations Framework

THE CHALLENGE

SCZONE had no formal warehouse regulations in place — inventory and custody procedures relied on informal practice rather than a documented, governed framework.

Approach

- ✓ Benchmarked and analyzed multiple reference frameworks — including the Ministry of Communications, the Financial Regulatory Authority, West Delta Electricity, and the government's standard warehouse regulations.
- ✓ Independently drafted the full text of a new warehouse regulations framework tailored to SCZONE's operations, using AI tools to accelerate research and drafting.
- ✓ Currently progressing through the legal review stage ahead of formal approval.

Status & Impact

- ★ On track to become SCZONE's first standardized, documented warehouse governance framework.
- ★ Built entirely through individual initiative, without external consultancy support.
- ★ Reflects the same regulatory drafting and benchmarking discipline required to structure investor-facing agreements.



Procurement & Contracts Regulations

THE CHALLENGE

As Section Head, led a 5-person team tasked with building SCZONE's unified procurement and contracts regulations framework.

Approach

- ✓ Assigned each team member to review and analyze a specific reference company's procurement regulations, extracting the clauses best aligned with SCZONE's operating system.
- ✓ Consolidated all findings in a joint working session to merge the best-fit provisions into a single framework.
- ✓ Co-authored the first draft of the unified procurement regulations as a team.

Results & Impact

- ★ The Procurement & Contracts Regulations was formally approved and remains in effect at SCZONE today.
- ★ Gave the department a single, consistent reference for procurement decisions instead of scattered practices.
- ★ Built cross-team consensus-building and drafting skills directly transferable to negotiating multi-party investor agreements.

More Work Across the Procurement Lifecycle



General Procurement Projects

End-to-end procurement of vehicles, IT equipment, office furniture, and critical spare parts — balancing compliance, competitive pricing, and delivery timelines.



Infrastructure Upgrade Projects

Procurement and coordination of major works, including Adabia Port development and the installation of a complete sewage station.



Security & Safety Systems Projects

Sourcing and implementation of fire-suppression networks, explosive-detection devices, and investor communication systems.



International Import Projects

Complex cross-border procurement of navigational devices (Vissim — Norway), marine spare parts (Mapso — Switzerland), and a gas-station unit (Pietro Fiorentini — Italy), each with full regulatory compliance and customs clearance.



Consultancy & Technical Studies Projects

Collaboration with global consultants on environmental studies for Ain Sokhna Port and procurement supervision for the Port Said Quays development program.

A Toolkit Built for Deal-Making



Negotiation & Stakeholder Relations

- ✓ Strategic Negotiation
- ✓ Long-Term Relationship Building
- ✓ Cross-Functional Collaboration
- ✓ Commercial Evaluation & RFP Management



Contracts, Trade & Compliance

- ✓ Contract Drafting, Review & Follow-Up
- ✓ FIDIC / USAID Compliance
- ✓ International Trade & Letters of Credit (LCs)
- ✓ Official Correspondence & Memo Drafting



Financial & Strategic Analysis

- ✓ Budget Planning & Management
- ✓ Feasibility Studies & Market Research
- ✓ Investor Evaluation Frameworks
- ✓ Strategic Planning



Inventory, Technology & AI

- ✓ SAP MM & Demand Forecasting
- ✓ Safety Stock Planning & Annual Audits
- ✓ Power BI & Advanced Excel / PowerPoint
- ✓ AI-Driven Supplier Evaluation & Data Analysis

Continuous Learning, Purposefully Applied



Education

Master's Degree in Supply Chain Management

Arab Academy for Science, Technology & Maritime Transport (AASTMT) — In Progress
Coursework: Strategic Planning, Supply Chain Management, Lean & Quality Management

Bachelor's Degree in Commerce (Accounting)

Suez University, Egypt

Associate Degree in Management Information Systems

Suez Institute for Management Information Systems, Egypt



Certifications

- **PMP — Project Management Professional**
PMI · Currently Studying
- **Supply Chain Management**
LinkedIn Learning
- **Negotiation Skills**
LinkedIn Learning
- **Project Management Foundations: Procurement**
LinkedIn Learning
- **Inventory Management Foundations**
LinkedIn Learning
- **Problem-Solving & Troubleshooting**
LinkedIn Learning

Representing Egypt on the International Stage



Industrial Transformation & Economic Development Seminar

AIBO / China Ministry of Commerce (MOFCOM) — Beijing, China | Jul-Aug 2024

Selected as part of the official Egyptian delegation under China's Global Development Initiative at the New Industrialization Conference — direct, first-hand exposure to international economic-development and investment-promotion dialogue.



Behavioral Barriers in Leadership

National Center for Training and Leadership (NCTL), Egypt • 2022



Anti-Corruption Training

National Anti-Corruption Academy, Egypt • 2022



Let's Build SCZONE's Next Chapter of Investor Partnerships

Thank you for reviewing my portfolio. I look forward to the opportunity to bring my procurement, negotiation, and analytical experience to the Investment & Promotion team.



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